INLAND EMPIRE MEDICAL NETWORK, INC.
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Scabies Treatment

What is scabies infection?

Scabies is caused by the mite *Sarcoptes scabiei*. Human scabies mites ate attracted to the warmth and smell of human. Female mites burrow into the skin, creating small thread-like markings or tunnels. The mites lay eggs and leave oval shaped feces in these tunnels. These products cause severe itchiness (allergic reaction). Scratching may then leave red tiny crusted bumps, scabs, or mosquito-like bites throughout your skin, except above the neck area (head). Unfortunately, an infected person may only have 10-15 scabies mites under their skin so even an extensive skin scraping could miss these itchy critters.

How scabies infection spread?

1. **By scratching:** Touching or scratching an area / tunnels that is infested with mites/eggs can spread them to other parts of the body. Your fingernails serve as the vehicles.
2. **By close contacts:** Scabies usually is spread by close contact, such as sleeping in the same bed or exposing to or touching the infected person in the same room. Anyone, any socioeconomic status, can become infected.
3. **By skin-to-skin or skin-to-fabric**: Scabies mite can live up to 36 hours without human host. The mites usually spread through skin-to-skin contact, but can also spread by contact with beddings, clothings, and other contaminated items.
4. **By contact with animal carriers**: The scabies mite that infests humans does not normally affect dogs or other pets. Similarly, animal-transmitted scabies mites can't reproduce on humans, so only animal treatment is necessary to end an infestation. Pets can be temporary carriers of human mites.
5. **By your unawareness of being infected**: Several weeks may pass before you develop symptoms of itch or rash; Hence you may be unaware that you are infected. You and anyone you have close contact with must all be treated at once.

Treatment options? Everyone in close contact with infected person should be treated at the same time.

1. **Topicals:** ***Elimite 5% Cream (Permethrin);*** ***Eurax 10% Lotion/Cream (Crotamiton);***
   - At bedtime, apply the cream to completely cover skin from neck down to toes, fingers, and nails. Avoid mucosal membranes of genitalia.
   - Leave on overnight (8-14 hours) and wear an old T-shirt.
   - Wash off & scrub from head to toes in the morning, moisturize skin, and apply anti-itch creams.
   - Repeat same routine in 1 wk (since eggs laid can hatch unaffected by cream and start re-infection).
2. **Oral Treatment**:
   - ***Ivermectin* 3 mg** x 5-6 tablets in one dose (200 *mcg*/kg). [200 *mcg*/kg x ___ kg = ___ *mcg* = ____ mg]
3. **Treating itchiness:** {*Keep skin well-hydrated with lotion; itchiness may persists up to 4-8 wks after*}
   - **Mid-potency to high-potency steroid (anti-itch) cream**: Apply once or twice a day for up to 8 weeks.
     - ☐ ***Triamcinolone*** 0.1% cream or ointment (*Kenalog*)
     - ☐ ***Mometasone*** 0.1% cream or ointment (*Elocon*)
     - ☐ ***Fluocinonide*** 0.05% cream (*Lidex*)
     - ☐ _____
   - **Oral antihistamines**: (*Caution with extreme drowsiness*)
     - ☐ Hydroxyzine 25mg : 1-2 tablets every 6-8 hours if needed for itchiness
     - ☐ Doxepine 25 mg : 1-2 tablets at bedtime if needed
     - ☐ Benadryl 25 mg: 1-2 tablets every 8 hours if needed
     - ☐ _____

4. **Treating clothings, towels, and beddings exposed to scabies mites**: The next day after application of Elimite cream, clean all affected items exposed (within the pass 3 days), with very hot water and double rinse them. Unwashable items can be placed in a closed plastic bag for at least 7 days or dry clean them. Sweep and vacuum the floors & sofas of the affected rooms and bathrooms. Any other extra cleaning efforts are NOT necessary, eg., washing carpets, draperies, walls or furnitures (chairs).

5. **Other alternative therapy that may be commercially available, but also may be controversial**:

- Australian tree oil: Not only does it kill scabies mites but it actually soothes your skin at the same time.
- If you want to immediately eliminate the redness associated with scabies, simply crack open a Vitamin E gel-cap and spread it on your sores.
- Balsam of Peru, an essential oil extracted from certain South American trees, is an excellent scabies killer. Just mix it with olive oil then apply to areas with bumps. Careful with contact allergy!
- A controversial natural scabies remedy from the 1930's that kills scabies mites by robbing them of oxygen, eg. applying olive oil or duct tape.
- The "Indian Wonder Tree": Why the leaves of this strange tree seem to possess magical powers of health and vitality and how you can use these leaves to kill scabies on the spot.
- ***Dermasil*** : Active ingredients in **Dermisil for Scabies Liquid** are: ***cymbopogon citratus, melaleuca alternifolia, and jojoba plant extracts***. Active ingredients in **Dermisil for Scabies Topical Treatment** are: ***10% lac sulfuris, jojoba, and melaleuca alternifolia*** extracts in a water-soluble hypo-allergenic base. Active ingredient in **BenzaRid** is: Benzalkonium chloride. *www.dermasil.com*

6. **WHAT NOT TO DO :**

- ☐ Don't attempt to treat scabies on your own with home remedies, without FIRST consulting with your physician.
- ☐ Don't use steroids or any other creams unless prescribed by or consulted with a dermatologist.
- ☐ Scrubbing your skin with laundry detergent or hand soaps, or applying kerosene will only make the condition much worse.

**** Some scabies medicines are not safe for children, older adults, and women who are pregnant or breast-feeding. To avoid dangerous side effects, be sure to follow your doctor's instructions carefully. If you have scabies, you and anyone you have close contact with must all be treated at the same time. This keeps the mites from being passed back and forth from person to person.**

After treatment, the itching usually lasts another 4-8 weeks. It will take your body that long to get over the allergic reaction caused by the mites. If you still have symptoms after 4 weeks, you may need another treatment... so remember to follow up with your physician.

For more information you can visit website : *www.body.aol.com*